

ArenaLink v1.0.3 — Operator Guide

Winsford Swim Team | Arena League Gala Recording

Before You Start

1. Launch ArenaLink using the desktop shortcut.
2. Open the Arena League spreadsheet in Excel.

Make sure Excel shows no read-only warning — close and reopen if needed.

3. Check the status bar shows **Watching:** and that the correct network drive is shown.
4. Check the top of the screen shows the correct team (A TEAMS or B TEAMS).

If the wrong team is shown, click the gear icon to open Settings.

Normal Race Flow

1. Timing file arrives automatically — app comes to front.
2. Check the Event and Race number match what was just swum.
3. Verify lane times look correct on screen.
4. Click FILL SPREADSHEET — times are written to Excel.
5. Check the spreadsheet row. Times are entered without colons or dots — e.g. 1:23.45 becomes 12345. This is normal and expected.
6. Click ENTRY DONE — unlocks the next race.

The app also auto-copies times to clipboard as a backup.

Indicators

- Green button — copied and ready to paste
- Yellow panel — backup time used, ref notified, no action needed
- Orange panel — empty lane detected, confirm before proceeding
- * after a time — backup time was used for that lane
- LANE EMPTY — no swimmer was recorded for that lane

If Files Queue Up

Files that arrive before you click Entry Done are queued automatically.

A yellow alert shows how many are waiting.

After clicking Entry Done the next file loads immediately.

Settings (gear icon)

- Watch Folder — path to timing system network share
- Team — A Teams = Heat 1, B Teams = Heat 2
- Excel Path — path to the scoring spreadsheet
- Auto-fill — enable or disable Fill Spreadsheet button
- Delete Log — reset processed file history

If ArenaLink Crashes

1. Relaunch ArenaLink using the desktop shortcut.
2. Click Process Unprocessed Files.
3. Work through any missed races one by one as normal.

All processed races are logged — nothing is permanently lost.

Reviewing a Previous Race

Click Review a Previous File at the bottom of the screen.

Select the race from the list.

Click Fill Spreadsheet to re-fill if needed.

Click Exit Review Mode when done.

Processed & Confirmed — What's the difference?

Processed — ArenaLink has read the timing file and displayed the result on screen. This happens automatically when a file arrives.

Confirmed — You have reviewed the result, filled the spreadsheet, and clicked Entry Done. This tells ArenaLink the entry is complete and unlocks the next race.

The two-step flow is intentional — it gives the operator a moment to check each result before it goes into the spreadsheet. Entry Done is your sign-off that the data is correct.

Common Problems

- App shakes when I press X — a window is open. Close it first.
- Fill fails: Sheet 'Recording' not found — the tab has been renamed.
 - Rename it back to exactly: **Recording**
- Files not detected — check the network share is accessible.
- Wrong times or missing races — check correct team is set (A or B).
- ArenaLink won't start (tkinter error) — see README Troubleshooting for fix steps.

Emergency Manual Entry

If ArenaLink cannot fill the spreadsheet, enter times by hand.

The spreadsheet expects times in MMSSH format — no colons or dots.

To convert a time manually:

- 1:23.45 — remove colon and dot — enter as 12345
- 54.32 (under a minute) — enter as 5432
- 2:10.08 — enter as 21008

Column D = Lane 1, E = Lane 2, F = Lane 3, G = Lane 4.

Leave the cell blank if a lane was empty (DNS).